
LaunchLab 8

Lesson 8: What is Supabase and what is an API?

Two Things Your Site Still Can't Do

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1. It Forgets Everyone

For example, when you close your wordle clone tab, it has no idea who you were. It can't keep track of users, scores, or saved games

2. It Knows Only Its Own Files

It can't tell you anything that is live. This could be the weather, temperature, etc. It can only display what you typed in the original code.

Today you fix both

We will learn about **APIs** and **Authentication**.

- An **API** lets your site borrow data from someone else
- **Authentication** lets it remember who is here.

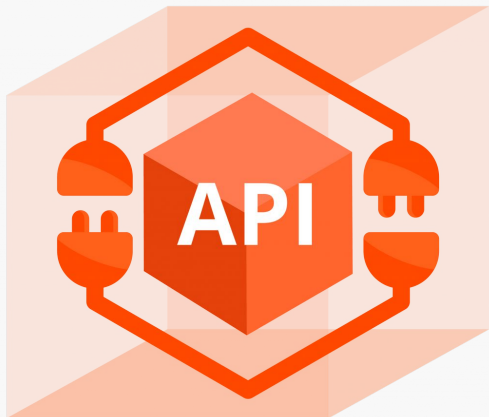
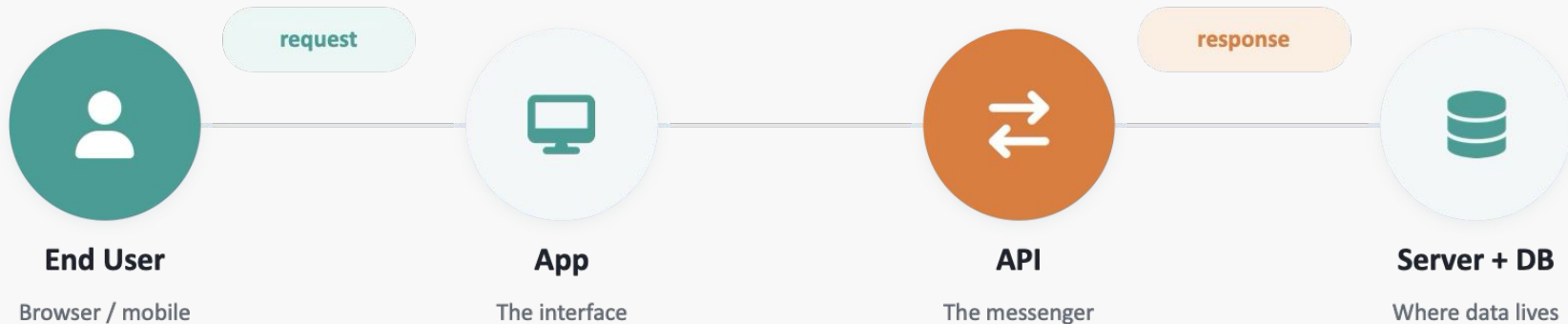
Now take 60 seconds

Go to supabase.com → click **Start your project** → **Continue with GitHub**.

We need the account later and it's faster to have it already.

Set up a database password and save it (this is NOT your login password). Pick the recommended region.

What an API Actually Is



Think of an API like a door. You knock with a request for information, it answers with data. You never see the inside, and you don't have to.

Watch This Video

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Task 1: Put Live Data On Your Page



1. Open Any Project

You can quickly fork the team wordle project you worked on last class and use the copy to do this.

2. Paste The Prompt Into Claude

3. Check It Worked

Refresh the page. A real temperature, from a real weather service, that changes every time you reload.

Paste This Into Claude

"When my page loads, fetch this URL:

`https://api.open-meteo.com/v1/
forecast?latitude=1.29&longitude=103.85
¤t=temperature_2m`

and show the current temperature in a small box at the top of the page."

This will update you site with the live temperature of Singapore.

*Remember to link the chat to the correct Repo and push the changes. Also make sure that new repo is connected to Vercel so that you can see changes.

How Logging In Works



Sign Up

When someone signs up on a website or app, it creates a new row in the user table. This table includes your email and a scrambled version of your password.

Log In

When you try to log in, it verifies if your email and password match what is registered in the user table. If they match, it will hand your browser a token.

Log Out

Logging out throws your token away. This means the site stops recognizing you until you log in again.

What A Token Is

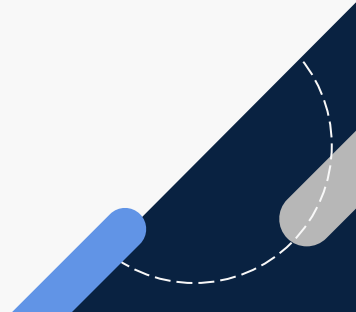
A token is a temporary sticker that says "this is James". Your browser shows it on every request, so the site doesn't ask for your password on every single click. It expires on its own.

Notice What All 3 Actions Are

Your site is sending a request to another computer and getting an answer back. Logging in is just an API call!



Your Turn!



Creating Login With Supabase

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1. Go To "Project Settings"

2. Go To "API Keys"

3. Copy "Publishable Key"

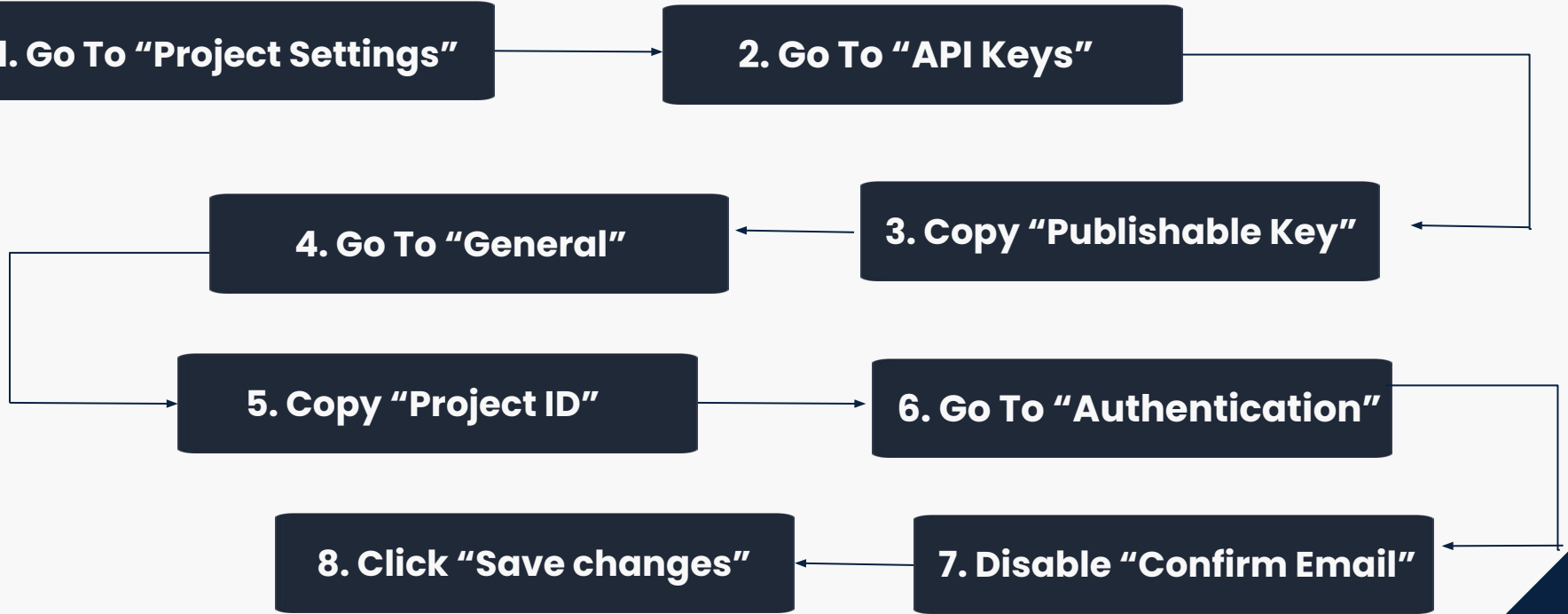
4. Go To "General"

5. Copy "Project ID"

6. Go To "Authentication"

7. Disable "Confirm Email"

8. Click "Save changes"



Creating Login With Supabase

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Paste This Into Claude

"Add email signup, login and logout to this page using Supabase.

Load supabase-js from
[https://cdn.jsdelivr.net/npm/
@supabase/supabase-js@2](https://cdn.jsdelivr.net/npm/@supabase/supabase-js@2)

Project URL: <https://<your project id>.supabase.co>
Publishable key: <paste yours>

When someone is logged in, show their email and a log out button."

This will add

1. One **script tag** that loads Supabase.
2. One line that connects using your two values.
3. Three buttons: sign up, log in, log out.



**Ask your tutor if you have
any questions!**

Next Lesson: Project Help

Homework: Work on Final Project